§ 08 · RESEARCH

Angels & **Family Offices**

Operator-angels, queer and female networks, family offices. Foelsch, Murray-Serter, Gaingels, Out Investors.

DOCUMENT
08 of 14 · research · investors

PREPARED
April 2026 · Berlin

STATUS
Pre-seed · confidential

Last updated: April 24, 2026 **Scope:** Europe, pre-seed, consumer wellness / longevity / DTC / AI-consumer **Founder context:** Berlin, solo, queer — fit for queer-friendly + female-friendly networks explicitly flagged **Raise target:** €500K pre-seed

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How to use this document

Sections 1–7 group entities by type (operator-angels, medical/longevity, queer networks, female networks, family offices, institutional angels/syndicates, and scout programmes). Each entry includes the 10-field brief the research spec called for. Section 8 is the prioritised outreach list.

Two flags to watch: - **QF** = explicitly queer-founder-friendly - **FF** = explicitly female-founder-friendly - **OP** = operator-angel with retail/supplement expertise (gold for Alche)

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1. Operator-Angel Networks & Founder-Angels (supplements, DTC, wellness)

1.1 Fabian Foelsch — BRAINEFFECT founder [OP]

- **Link:** https://www.linkedin.com/in/fabianfoelsch / https://braineffect.com
- **Type:** Individual operator-angel (Berlin)
- **Check size:** €25K–€100K typical angel tickets
- **Sector focus:** Supplements, functional nutrition, DTC. Built BRAINEFFECT from scratch, sold majority to Schwabe Group (2020), retained leadership. €1M+ units sold 2024; retail at dm + Budni; multi-country (DE/AT/CH/FR).
- **Identity fit:** Germany/Berlin based, strategic-investor ethos
- **Key contact:** Fabian Foelsch, CEO/Founder — LinkedIn DM or warm intro via Berlin supplement founder circle
- **Process:** Referral-preferred. Has publicly stated preference for strategic investors and family offices over VC for profitable consumer models
- **Recent wellness deals:** Active as angel (exact portfolio non-public), known to back DTC consumer-health founders
- **Value-add:** Deep supplement formulation + German retail (dm, Budni) + influencer marketing playbook + Schwabe Group network
- **Fit score: 10/10** — perfect match. Same country, same category, same retail universe, proven preference for the exact deal type Alche is.

1.2 Dan Murray-Serter — Heights co-founder [OP]

- **Link:** https://www.danielmurray.com
- **Type:** Individual operator-angel (London)
- **Check size:** £10K–£50K; 100+ startups in personal portfolio
- **Sector focus:** Brain-care, supplements, DTC, consumer brands. Scaled Heights to £30M ARR 2026.
- **Identity fit:** UK-friendly, very active in founder-first / mission-led deals
- **Key contact:** Dan Murray-Serter on LinkedIn; also reachable via Secret Leaders podcast inbound or Foundrs community
- **Process:** Cold-accepting via LinkedIn + Foundrs community; highly reachable
- **Recent wellness deals:** Active in 100+ deals, personally involved in braincare/gut-brain/supplement ecosystem
- **Value-add:** Playbook for subscription supplements, £35M brand build, Men's Health / mainstream media reach, 50M-download podcast platform
- **Fit score: 9/10** — twin-brain category, same subscription-DTC model, massive media megaphone

1.3 Damian Soong — Form Nutrition co-founder [OP]

- **Link:** https://damiansoong.com

- **Type:** Individual operator-angel (London)
- **Check size:** Small angel tickets; also advisor roles
- **Sector focus:** Plant-based protein, B-Corp consumer, vegan supplements (Men's Health "Protein Pioneer")
- **Identity fit:** Values-led / purpose-driven founder lens
- **Key contact:** Damian Soong on LinkedIn; Form Nutrition founding team also approachable
- **Process:** Referral-preferred; used family-office money himself — connects founders to patient capital
- **Recent wellness deals:** Quiet angel; his network (Equinox retail, B-Corp community) is the leverage
- **Value-add:** Global-retail distribution playbook (Equinox, Whole Foods UK), B-Corp certification, sustainable packaging, plant-based formulation
- **Fit score: 8/10** — retail playbook is directly transferable for Alche's own-brand future

1.4 Stefan & Anne Lemcke — Ankerkraut founders [OP]

- **Link:** https://www.linkedin.com/in/stefan-lemcke / https://ankerkraut.de
- **Type:** Individual operator-angels (Hamburg/Germany)
- **Check size:** €10K–€50K
- **Sector focus:** Food & beverage, DTC, community-led consumer. Exited Ankerkraut to Nestlé (2022, ~€180M rumoured).
- **Identity fit:** German-ecosystem native, community-centric
- **Key contact:** Stefan Lemcke (CEO/Founder), Anne Lemcke (Co-Founder) via LinkedIn
- **Process:** Shizune ranks them top-50 angels in Germany across food & beverage, community, fashion. Moderately cold-accepting
- **Recent wellness deals:** Active in food & beverage / community startup rankings
- **Value-add:** Community-first brand building, Nestlé network, German DTC operational depth
- **Fit score: 8/10** — community-led commerce is exactly Alche's "Xiaohongshu for longevity" angle

1.5 Peter Attia — Early Medical / Biograph co-founder [OP – longevity-flagship]

- **Link:** https://peterattiamd.com
- **Type:** Individual angel-investor (US, global reach)
- **Check size:** Variable; 14 public investments incl. Molten Industries, HumanCo, LMNT
- **Sector focus:** Longevity diagnostics, supplements (AG1 advisor/investor), clean electrolytes, preventive health
- **Identity fit:** US-based but globally networked; halo-effect on longevity category — his name on the captable is magnetic
- **Key contact:** Very hard to reach directly; best path is via Biograph team, Early Medical, or his podcast production team
- **Process:** Referral-only, nearly impossible cold. Warm intro via any of his 14 portfolio founders
- **Recent wellness deals:** AG1 (Series B), HumanCo, LMNT, Molten Industries, Biograph (co-founded)
- **Value-add:** Unparalleled longevity halo; direct access to longevity physician network (Attia-style MDs)
- **Fit score: 7/10** for likelihood (low-probability yes), **10/10** for halo-if-yes. Aim to close him as advisor even if he passes on cheque.

1.6 Innocent Founders / JamJar Investments [OP]

- **Link:** https://www.jamjarinvestments.com
- **Type:** Consumer-exclusive VC (London), founded by Richard Reed, Jon Wright, Adam Balon, Katie Marraché
- **Check size:** £100K–£5M (seed to Series A)
- **Sector focus:** European consumer brands — food/drink, beauty, health/wellness, fintech, marketplaces
- **Identity fit:** Mission/brand-led ethos; very founder-friendly
- **Key contact:** Katie Marraché (ex-Innocent, now partner), team at jamjarinvestments.com/team
- **Process:** Cold-accepting via website; better warm intro via any Innocent/portfolio alum
- **Recent wellness deals:** Wild (natural deodorants), SURI (oral care), Runna (running), Xoxo (functional soda)
- **Value-add:** £700M-exit founders with deepest consumer-brand playbook in Europe; Coca-Cola network
- **Fit score: 9/10** — category fit, check size fit, exactly the "consumer brand at pre-seed/seed" thesis

1.7 Venrex Investment Partners [OP — beauty/wellness]

- **Link:** https://venrex.partners
- **Type:** Early-stage consumer VC (London/NY), founded 2002
- **Check size:** $130K–$1.3M (Venrex BBCo I fund); broader fund £5M–£50M for premium DTC

- **Sector focus:** Consumer, beauty, wellness, DTC. 125 portfolio companies. Beauty fund co-built with British Beauty Council.
- **Identity fit:** Premium-brand DNA (Charlotte Tilbury, ME+EM, Revolut); backs founders early
- **Key contact:** Mark Esiri (co-founder), Tom Fleming (Founder) — venrex.partners team page
- **Process:** Website accepts inbound; strongly warm-intro preferred
- **Recent wellness deals:** Throne (gut wellness/hydration), Yepoda (K-beauty DTC), Graymatter Labs (nootropic drink), FC Labs (brain-fitness wearable), Freaks of Nature (personal products, Jan 2026)
- **Value-add:** Charlotte Tilbury-scale brand network; direct beauty-retail intros; British Beauty Council leverage
- **Fit score: 9/10** — Throne + Graymatter in portfolio = direct thesis alignment

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2. Medical, Longevity & Nutrition Professionals Investing

2.1 Peter Attia's MD network

- See 1.5 above. Adjacent names to search when Attia says no: **Mark Hyman MD** (US, functional medicine), **Rhonda Patrick PhD** (FoundMyFitness), **David Sinclair PhD** (Harvard longevity).
- **Fit score: 7/10** — Attia-style MDs are globally distributed; Europe MDs with longevity shingle are thinner but growing (see Alche's DE doctor outreach list separately).

2.2 Biograph backers (US-centric but relevant halo)

- **Link:** Biograph (peteratia co-founded, emerged Feb 2025)
- **Backers:** Vy Capital, Human Capital, Alpha Wave, WndrCo, Balaji Srinivasan (angel)
- **Fit score: 4/10** — too US-centric for €500K, but useful positioning reference. Mention if pitching to crypto/wellness angels.

2.3 Chris Ashenden — ex-AG1 founder [OP]

- **Link:** https://www.crunchbase.com/person/chris-ashenden
- **Type:** Ex-founder. Resigned AG1 in 2024 amid pre-AG1 legal revelations; next move unclear as of April 2026.
- **Fit score: 3/10** — reputational drag + uncertain next move. Skip unless a very specific warm intro emerges.

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3. Queer Founder-Friendly Networks [QF priority]

3.1 identity.vc [QF — top priority]

- **Link:** https://identity.vc
- **Type:** Dedicated LGBTQ+ VC fund, Art. 9 SFDR impact fund, Berlin-HQ
- **Check size:** €250K–€1.5M (pre-seed to Series A); targeting 25 companies; 50% reserve for follow-on
- **Sector focus:** Sector-agnostic with emphasis on AI, sustainability, demographic change, security. Invests in startups with LGBTQ+ representation in leadership (with equity).
- **Identity fit:** Europe's only LGBTQ+-first VC fund. Berlin-headquartered. EXACT fit for Alche.
- **Key contacts: Til Klein** (founding partner, ex-BCG/UBS/fintech founder), **Jochen Beutgen** (founding partner, 20-yr family-office VC), **Mari Luukkainen** (Principal, ex-icebreaker.vc)
- **Process:** Apply via identity.vc; Slack community (300+ members) hosts founders; events in Berlin, Amsterdam, Paris, Madrid
- **Recent deals:** Frontnow (AI retail), Omni (vegan dog food, London), Peec AI, eco.mio
- **Value-add:** LGBTQ+ investor community, European events calendar, follow-on capacity
- **Fit score: 10/10** — Berlin-based, queer-first, consumer-wellness-capable, check size fits. **Must-pitch.**

3.2 Out Investors (DACH chapter) [QF]

- **Link:** https://www.outinvestors.com
- **Type:** Global LGBT+ professional network with Berlin/DACH chapter; 130+ partner investment orgs (PE/VC/HF)
- **Check size:** Individual members write personal angel cheques (varies €5K–€100K)
- **Sector focus:** Sector-agnostic; investment-industry professionals
- **Identity fit:** Queer-investor network across all asset classes; Berlin chapter is active

- **Key contact:** Berlin chapter leads via outinvestors.com (events calendar + chapter contacts)
- **Process:** Attend Berlin chapter events; refer-and-be-referred model
- **Recent deals:** Network provides access to decision-makers at partner orgs; not a fund itself
- **Value-add:** Institutional warm intros to PE/VC via the 130+ partner firms
- **Fit score: 9/10** — highest-leverage queer network in DACH for institutional follow-on

3.3 Gaingels [QF]

- **Link:** https://gaingels.com
- **Type:** LGBTQIA+/Allies syndicate, 4,800+ members, 3,700+ accredited, Burlington VT HQ (global reach incl. Europe)
- **Check size:** Usually co-invests $10–50M at Series A/B (large rounds); Europe pre-seed participation via ecosystem partners — smaller brackets possible
- **Sector focus:** LGBTQ-founded/led companies, sector-agnostic
- **Identity fit:** World's largest LGBTQIA+ syndicate; ~$600M deployed since 2019
- **Key contact: David Beatty** (co-founder, still active), Paul Grossinger, plus deal-sourcing team
- **Process:** Typically joins lead-VC-led rounds; direct cold harder, warm intro via lead VC preferred. Can participate in European pre-seed if a credible lead is already committed.
- **Recent deals:** Participation in RapidFort, Harness (2025-26) + hundreds at pre-seed via syndicate
- **Value-add:** Thousands of queer allies, follow-on capacity, US access
- **Fit score: 7/10** — best unlocked once Alche has a lead. Secondary push.

3.4 Proud Ventures (UK) [QF]

- **Link:** https://www.proud-ventures.com
- **Type:** Intimate LGBTQ+ VC/angel community (UK-based), founded 2020
- **Check size:** Members are individual VCs/angels — varies widely
- **Sector focus:** Sector-agnostic
- **Identity fit:** Community-first model; backed by Investec Wealth + Wilson Sonsini Goodrich & Rosati
- **Key contact:** Reach via proud-ventures.com contact or LinkedIn; summit attendees include Seedcamp, Breega, Frontline, Earlybird, Inovia, Playfair
- **Process:** Intimate community — warm intro required
- **Recent deals:** Not a fund; their 2023 report on UK LGBTQ+ founders is reference
- **Value-add:** Gateway to top-tier UK VCs who are LGBTQ+ allies
- **Fit score: 7/10** — a route into UK VC follow-on more than a pre-seed cheque

3.5 Gay Investor Network (GIN) — UK accredited syndicate [QF]

- **Link:** Via https://ukbaa.org.uk (launched April 2026 as UKBAA-accredited syndicate)
- **Type:** UK's first accredited LGBTQ+ angel syndicate, launched April 2026
- **Check size:** Syndicate tickets £50K–£500K range typical for UKBAA syndicates
- **Sector focus:** Sector-agnostic, founder-background-diverse
- **Identity fit:** Brand new, hungry for deals — Alche could be an early showcase deal
- **Key contact:** Via UKBAA newsletter / GIN founder announcements (research current chair)
- **Process:** Accepts pitches via UKBAA portal; new network so onboarding is active
- **Recent deals:** Too new — launching cohort 2026
- **Value-add:** UKBAA stamp of accreditation; UK follow-on signals
- **Fit score: 8/10** — brand-new network, hungry, aligned. Apply early.

3.6 The Pride Fund / Pride.VC [QF]

- **Link:** https://pride.vc
- **Type:** VC firm (Columbus, OH) with Loud Capital ecosystem
- **Check size:** Small tickets; has deployed $5M across 54 companies
- **Sector focus:** LGBTQ+ founder-led, pre-seed to Series A
- **Identity fit:** US-centric but open to global LGBTQ+ founders

- **Key contact:** CEO via pride.vc form
- **Fit score: 5/10** — US-centric, smaller cheques; low-priority unless building a broader syndicate.

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4. Female Founder-Friendly Networks [FF priority]

4.1 Auxxo Female Catalyst Fund II [FF]

- **Link:** https://auxxo.de
- **Type:** Berlin-HQ VC, sector-agnostic, pre-seed/seed, female-cofounder-required (≥20% founder shares)
- **Check size:** Fund II = €26M first close (target €50M); co-leads rounds; tickets typically €500K–€2M now
- **Sector focus:** Sector-agnostic; already backing Emidat (construction data), Resolutiion (legal AI), Stanhope AI (neuroscience)
- **Identity fit:** 50%+ female LPs; Berlin-headquartered; deeply networked
- **Key contact: Dr. Gesa Miczaika** (Co-Founder/Partner), **Bettine Schmitz** (Co-Founder), Alena Redeker, Sophie Pollok, Katharina Heße, Melanie Higgs
- **Process:** Website application; LPs include EIF, Aurum Impact, Cherry Ventures, Speedinvest — warm intro from any of those is gold
- **Recent deals:** Fund II investments announced 2025-26
- **Value-add:** Female-first community, Berlin ecosystem, 6x TVPI on 2019 vintage = signal value
- **Fit score: NOTE:** Alche is solo queer *male* founder. Auxxo requires ≥20% female cofounder. **Only fits if Alche adds a female co-founder/early exec.** Otherwise: **3/10** (structural mismatch). Flag clearly.

4.2 encourageventures [FF]

- **Link:** https://www.encourageventures.com
- **Type:** German female investor network (Berlin-ecosystem); syndicate + Business Angel Academy
- **Check size:** Syndicate deals typically €100K–€500K total round participation; per-angel €5K–€50K
- **Sector focus:** Sector-agnostic; ≥1 female (co-)founder required
- **Identity fit:** Same structural filter as Auxxo — requires female founder. **Would not fit Alche as solo queer male founder.**
- **Key contacts: Ina Schlie** (initiator, ex-SAP VP), Ana-Cristina Grohnert (Diversity Charter), Brigitte Zypries (ex-German Minister of Economics), Tina Müller (ex-Douglas CEO)
- **Fit score: 3/10** for direct investment. **8/10** as a community-partner / brand-ally / advisor channel if Alche builds with a female co-founder or partners on female-specific content. Flag as conditional.

4.3 Alma Angels [FF, possibly QF-adjacent]

- **Link:** Via Speedinvest + Deepali Nangia (co-founder)
- **Type:** Pan-European women-focused angel community, 400+ female investors
- **Check size:** Individual tickets; collectively syndicated rounds
- **Sector focus:** Female/underrepresented founders; partners with Speedinvest for deal flow
- **Identity fit:** Supports female AND underrepresented founders — queer founder signal may unlock some members even without female co-founder
- **Key contact: Deepali Nangia** (Speedinvest Partner, Alma co-founder) — UKBAA Angel Investor of the Year 2021
- **Process:** Via Speedinvest deal flow or direct LinkedIn to Nangia
- **Recent deals:** Nangia personally has backed 30+ female founders; Atomico Angel alum
- **Value-add:** Speedinvest channel + mentor network + UKBAA recognition
- **Fit score: 6/10** direct (structural bias female); **9/10** if framed as underrepresented/LGBTQ+ angle. **Strong relationship-building target.**

4.4 Calm/Storm Ventures [FF, femtech/tabootech]

- **Link:** https://www.calmstorm.vc
- **Type:** Vienna-HQ digital-health VC, €30M fund, pre-seed/seed
- **Check size:** €50K–€250K; 60+ portfolio
- **Sector focus:** Femtech, tabootech, mental health, sexual wellness, fertility, chronic care

- **Identity fit:** Diversity emphasis (50% portfolio with diverse teams); female-founder-friendly but not required
- **Key contact:** General application via calmstorm.vc; team listed on site
- **Process:** Website accepts inbound; active on Twitter/LinkedIn
- **Recent deals:** Meela, Levy, Keleya, Foundation Health, Holo, LillianCare
- **Value-add:** Europe's #1 super-early digital health fund; femtech cred
- **Fit score: 7/10** — if Alche leans the pitch toward preventive health + taboo/female-healthspan angles, strong fit. Queer-friendly signal implicit.

4.5 Goddess Gaia Ventures (London) [FF, women's health]

- **Link:** Search "Goddess Gaia Ventures"
- **Type:** London-based VC, women's healthcare focus
- **Check size:** Pre-Series A; co-invests
- **Sector focus:** Fertility, cancer, wellness, chronic disease, femtech
- **Identity fit:** 50% portfolio diverse teams; 1/3 non-male CEOs
- **Fit score: 5/10** — women's-health first; Alche is broader longevity so tangential. Possible as follow-on.

4.6 Verena Pausder — individual female angel [FF, OP]

- **Link:** https://signal.nfx.com/investors/verena-pausder
- **Type:** Berlin super-angel; Chairwoman German Startup Association; co-host Fast & Curious podcast
- **Check size:** €25K–€100K typical
- **Sector focus:** Broad; prefers sustainable + female-led; has backed consumer, fintech, edtech, food (Perfeggt plant-egg)
- **Identity fit:** Vocal advocate for underrepresented founders incl. women, sustainability
- **Key contact:** Verena Pausder on LinkedIn; podcast-accessible
- **Process:** Warm intro strongly preferred; cold DM-able given public profile
- **Recent deals:** Nelly (Series B, 2024), Karri (pre-seed), plus 25 investments
- **Value-add:** German startup-association reach, 50+ podcast reach, policy access
- **Fit score: 8/10** — Berlin, super-active, policy-plugged, values-aligned

4.7 Sophia Bendz — Cherry Ventures GP / angel [FF, OP wellness]

- **Link:** https://cherry.vc/team/sophia-bendz
- **Type:** General Partner Cherry Ventures (Stockholm base), 52 personal angel investments
- **Check size:** Personal angel €10K–€100K; Cherry fund tickets €500K+
- **Sector focus:** Personally — femtech, women's health, climate impact. Portfolio: Oura, Clue, Daye, Manual, Sana Labs, Ferly, Simple Feast.
- **Identity fit:** First female partner at Cherry; Atomico Angel Programme architect; Nordic Angels "Mentor of the Year"
- **Key contact:** Sophia Bendz on LinkedIn; Cherry Ventures Berlin/Stockholm
- **Process:** Warm intro (Cherry portfolio founders) or LinkedIn; she's reachable
- **Recent deals:** Oura (smart ring), Clue (period tracking), Manual (men's health)
- **Value-add:** Femtech playbook, Spotify + Atomico alumni network, Nordic Angels access
- **Fit score: 9/10** — personally invested in Oura/Clue (direct category analogues); Cherry fund is Berlin-native

4.8 Ada Ventures (UK) [FF, underrepresented]

- **Link:** https://adaventures.com
- **Type:** London VC, $34M fund, FF with intersectional thesis
- **Check size:** ~£500K–£2M seed
- **Sector focus:** Overlooked founders/markets; portfolio includes Alvie Health (just exited Feb 2026)
- **Key contact: Francesca Warner** (co-founder/GP)
- **Fit score: 6/10** — UK-first focus; intersectional thesis reads well for queer founders even without female co-founder requirement

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5. Family Offices & Corporate Venture (wellness mandates)

5.1 Heal Capital [digital health, Berlin]

- **Link:** https://www.healcapital.com
- **Type:** Berlin-HQ healthtech VC, €200M+ AUM, backed by 25+ health insurers + pharma + institutional healthcare
- **Check size:** €1M–€5M (pre-seed to Series A)
- **Sector focus:** HealthTech + AI — software, digitally-enabled care, NOT therapeutics
- **Identity fit:** Insurance-industry backed = Alche's insurance-partnership play is a natural fit
- **Key contact: Markus Muschenich** (Founding Partner); team at healcapital.com
- **Process:** Website inbound; warm intro via any portfolio company founder
- **Recent deals:** FormlyAI (Seed June 2025), Gleamer (exit March 2026), Heal Capital 2 first startups announced June 2025
- **Value-add:** 25+ health insurer network = distribution/partnership for Alche's longevity data/insurance angle
- **Fit score: 7/10** — check size is a stretch for pre-seed; but valuable for seed follow-on. Build relationship now.

5.2 Schwabe Group / Natural X [supplements, pharma family]

- **Link:** Schwabe Group venture arm = **Natural X**; private pharma family
- **Type:** German family-owned pharma group; acquired majority of BRAINEFFECT (see 1.1)
- **Check size:** Strategic; typically €1M+ majority-path
- **Sector focus:** Digital health + nutritional supplements
- **Identity fit:** Perfectly aligned with Alche's supplement-commerce play; hands-on consumer supplement expertise
- **Key contact:** Via Fabian Foelsch (BRAINEFFECT) warm intro; Natural X investment team
- **Process:** Strategic investor; referral-only realistically
- **Recent deals:** BRAINEFFECT majority (2024), broader Natural X digital-health thesis
- **Value-add:** Pharma-grade supplier + regulatory + potential future acquirer
- **Fit score: 8/10** — long-term strategic optionality; acquire-the-acquirer relationship early.

5.3 Unilever Ventures [corporate beauty/wellness CVC]

- **Link:** https://www.unileverventures.com
- **Type:** CVC, est. 2002; top-5 most active CPG CVCs (CB Insights)
- **Check size:** Seed to Series A typical €1M–€10M
- **Sector focus:** Beauty, personal care, wellness; recent Nutrafol, True Botanicals, Gallinée, Beauty Bakerie, RAS (India), Live Tinted
- **Identity fit:** Strategic; Unilever divesting food, doubling down on beauty/wellness — longevity fits
- **Key contact:** Via unileverventures.com; team disclosed publicly
- **Process:** Warm intro from portfolio founder ideal; also submit through corporate innovation channels
- **Recent deals:** Live Tinted (with L'Oréal BOLD), RAS Luxury Skincare (India Series B)
- **Value-add:** Unilever distribution rails globally; massive strategic optionality
- **Fit score: 6/10** — too big for pre-seed lead but excellent Series A follow-on target. Seed with them possible.

5.4 L'Oréal BOLD + the L'Oréal × Kering Longevity JV [corporate CVC]

- **Link:** L'Oréal BOLD — https://www.loreal.com
- **Type:** Corporate VC; 19+ investments (Aug 2025)
- **Check size:** Minority stakes, typically $1M–$10M+
- **Sector focus:** Beauty, consumer, enterprise. **2026 watchlist:** L'Oréal-Kering 50/50 JV on luxury wellness and longevity (closing H1 2026).
- **Identity fit:** Perfectly aligned with Alche's longevity vertical
- **Key contact:** BOLD team via L'Oréal corporate innovation; track the Kering JV leadership announcement
- **Process:** Strategic; highly curated; warm intro essential
- **Recent deals:** Live Tinted (with Unilever Ventures); portfolio skews late-stage
- **Value-add:** Distribution + brand + longevity-category strategic narrative
- **Fit score: 6/10** now (pre-seed too early); **9/10** at Seed/Series A. Build relationship early via BOLD events.

5.5 Estée Lauder NIV — New Incubation Ventures [corporate CVC]

- **Link:** https://www.elcompanies.com/en/who-we-are/organizational-structure/new-incubation-ventures
- **Type:** Corporate incubation + early-stage VC
- **Check size:** Seed-to-A range; incubation model also
- **Sector focus:** Beauty, community, Web3 (KIKI World), emerging markets (XINU Mexico, Forest Essentials India)
- **Identity fit:** Early-stage-friendly; explicitly backs community-led commerce (Alche's Xiaohongshu thesis is on-brand)
- **Key contact:** NIV LinkedIn + ELC corporate innovation
- **Process:** Website / partnership submissions; warm intro helpful
- **Recent deals:** KIKI World (community commerce + blockchain), XINU (first Latin American investment), Forest Essentials (full acquisition)
- **Value-add:** Community-brand playbook; retail distribution via ELC brands
- **Fit score: 7/10** — community-commerce narrative aligns with Alche exactly

5.6 Hans(wo)men Group [Vienna family office, OP]

- **Link:** https://www.hansmengroup.com
- **Type:** Family office of Hansi Hansmann + daughter Lisa Hansmann
- **Check size:** Early-stage lead tickets; 100+ direct investments historically
- **Sector focus:** Sector-agnostic, pre-seed lead, Europe (AT/DE/UK/ES) — healthcare, consumer goods, fintech
- **Identity fit:** Lisa Hansmann focuses on diverse teams + sustainability + social impact; queer-friendly signal
- **Key contact: Hansi Hansmann** (senior), **Lisa Hansmann** (new-investment lead)
- **Process:** Referral-preferred; Hansmen Group events in Vienna
- **Recent deals:** Runtastic (exit), mySugr (exit, digital diabetes), Shpock (exit), Busuu (exit), Coinpanion
- **Value-add:** One of DACH's most successful angel track records; mySugr direct category relevance
- **Fit score: 9/10** — DACH, health-tech positive, lead-willing, new-gen diversity lens

5.7 European Super Angels Club (ESAC) [family offices + HNWIs]

- **Link:** https://superangels.club
- **Type:** Vienna-HQ pan-European investment club via EXF Alpha SCS Fund; 18 total investments, 6 leads
- **Check size:** Rounds of €1M–€10M (as a collective)
- **Sector focus:** Multi-sector; portfolio skews B2B but includes consumer
- **Identity fit:** Berlin launch event held; DACH footprint
- **Key contact:** Via superangels.club / Venionaire / KPMG Austria
- **Process:** Family-office members evaluate deals; referral-preferred
- **Fit score: 5/10** — good for seed follow-on, less fit for first pre-seed cheque

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6. Institutional Angel Networks, Syndicates & Scout Programmes

6.1 Angel Invest Ventures (Berlin) [OP-heavy]

- **Link:** https://angelinvest.ventures
- **Type:** Most active super-angel fund in Europe; 75+ startups/year, 240+ portfolio, €4BN combined market cap
- **Check size:** €125K typical; pre-seed through seed
- **Sector focus:** AI, FinTech, DeepTech stated — but historic consumer wellness bets include Kencko (nutrition) and Coachhub (wellness coaching)
- **Identity fit:** Berlin HQ; pro-founder, "coach founders for ≥1 year"
- **Key contacts: Jens Lapinski**, **Jag Singh**, **Mara Larson-Richard**, Karljo Seilern, Connor Murphy, Kartik Varma, Miguel Encarnacion, Matthaus Krzykowski
- **Process:** Website inbound + Jens/Jag LinkedIn accept cold. Happy to be first cheque pre-incorporation.
- **Recent deals:** DivTax (March 2026), Einklang, Modeinspect
- **Value-add:** Most-active Berlin super-angel brand; ≥1 year hands-on coaching; deep follow-on rolodex

- **Fit score: 9/10** — they may not scream wellness but their volume + Berlin-native + check size fit is perfect. **Core target.**

6.2 BACB (Business Angel Club Berlin-Brandenburg)

- **Link:** https://bacb.de
- **Type:** 140+ Berlin-Brandenburg business angels, EBAN member
- **Check size:** Syndicate participation €100K–€500K typical
- **Sector focus:** Consumer goods to deep tech; 85+ portfolio
- **Identity fit:** Berlin/Brandenburg-native; BACB Female Founders Contest 2026 shows diversity lean
- **Key contact:** BACB board via bacb.de
- **Process:** Apply via website; member pitches monthly
- **Value-add:** Hyper-local Berlin network; VC follow-on bridge
- **Fit score: 8/10** — Berlin-local = ideal tactical first angel syndicate to pitch

6.3 BAND — Business Angels Netzwerk Deutschland [umbrella]

- **Link:** https://www.business-angels.de
- **Type:** Germany-wide umbrella of angel networks, est. 1998, EBAN founding member
- **Check size:** Distributes to member networks; single-pager routing
- **Sector focus:** All sectors (note: Managing Director Alf Arnold has said he personally avoids consumer, but BAND's network members do invest in consumer)
- **Key contact: Alf Arnold** (Managing Director since June 2025)
- **Process:** Submit BAND One-Pager; gets routed to members
- **Value-add:** Systemic access to every German angel network
- **Fit score: 7/10** — not a cheque, but the most-efficient distribution for a one-pager

6.4 Atomico Angel Programme [scout]

- **Link:** https://atomico.com/insights
- **Type:** Invitation-only scout/angel programme, rolling admission, $100K per angel
- **Check size:** $25K–$100K per deal by individual angels; Alche's target = pitch individual angels
- **Sector focus:** Broad European; scouts are founders/operators
- **Identity fit:** Diversity-heavy selection; underrepresented backgrounds prioritised
- **Key contact:** Track current cohort via atomico.com; past alumni include Deepali Nangia, Des Traynor, Guillaume Pousaz, Nilan Peiris, Jonas Templestein
- **Process:** Cannot apply directly to the programme; must get an individual Atomico Angel to invest
- **Fit score: 8/10** — pitch individual angels one-by-one, not the programme. Especially target: Nangia + any consumer-wellness scouts.

6.5 Seedcamp (+AngelList syndicate + Expert Collective)

- **Link:** https://seedcamp.com
- **Type:** London-HQ pre-seed VC, 492+ portfolio, AngelList syndicate for co-invest, 100-expert "Expert Collective" (Revolut/Pleo/UiPath/Wise/Uber/Stripe alumni)
- **Check size:** Seedcamp fund €200K–€500K typical first cheque
- **Sector focus:** Software, AI, fintech, consumer as secondary; consumer-wellness is a stretch but possible
- **Identity fit:** Pan-European, founder-friendly, diverse portfolio
- **Key contact:** Team at seedcamp.com/team; Expert Collective via alumni
- **Process:** Website inbound — highly active
- **Recent deals:** 9fin, OutPost Bio, Ben, Lupin & Holmes, Andel
- **Value-add:** Expert Collective has wellness + consumer brand operators; AngelList syndicate channels accredited investors
- **Fit score: 7/10** — institutional cred + follow-on rolodex; consumer-wellness is the challenge on thesis

6.6 Cherry Ventures (Berlin HQ)

- **Link:** https://cherry.vc

- **Type:** Pan-EU pre-seed/seed, 130+ portfolio, Berlin/London/Stockholm
- **Check size:** €500K–€3M first cheque typical
- **Sector focus:** Consumer (Flink, Forto, SellerX), DTC, health tech, fintech
- **Identity fit:** Sophia Bendz on team = femtech/wellness lens; Berlin-native
- **Key contacts: Sophia Bendz** (already listed 4.7), **Filip Dames** (co-founder), **Christian Meermann** (co-founder), **Katharina Wilhelm**, **Charlotte Bruce**
- **Process:** Website inbound accepted; Bendz is the wellness-route in
- **Recent deals:** Riplo (workflow, March 2026)
- **Value-add:** Ex-Zalando/Spotify operator team; Berlin gravitational centre
- **Fit score: 8/10** — Berlin-native + Bendz wellness lens = clear path

6.7 Speedinvest (Marketplaces & Consumer team + Health & Bio team)

- **Link:** https://www.speedinvest.com
- **Type:** Pan-EU VC, €600M+ AUM, offices Berlin/London/Munich/Paris/Vienna
- **Check size:** Pre-seed/seed €200K–€2M
- **Sector focus:** Separate teams for Marketplaces & Consumer (network effects) AND Health & Bio (regulated AI+care)
- **Identity fit:** Deepali Nangia is partner here (queer/female ally + Alma Angels co-founder); pan-EU footprint
- **Key contact: Deepali Nangia** (MEA & Beyond + ESG + MicroGP), Marketplaces & Consumer team, Health & Bio team
- **Process:** Website inbound + Deepali Nangia LinkedIn (she is approachable)
- **Recent deals:** 587 portfolio companies; Blocks (Pre-Seed April 2026)
- **Value-add:** Platform+ operational experts; pan-EU, plus Middle East expansion; Nangia is a bridge to Alma Angels women/underrepresented community
- **Fit score: 8/10** — Nangia is the unlock; she personally invested in 30+ female founders + has wellness/digital health thesis from Atomico days

6.8 Zinc VC (London) [mission-driven, women's health + later-life]

- **Link:** https://www.zinc.vc
- **Type:** Venture builder + pre-seed fund, £28M Fund 2 first-close
- **Check size:** First cheque pre-seed; also runs 9-month venture-build programmes
- **Sector focus:** Four missions — mental health, environment, **quality of later life (longevity!)**, people impacted by automation
- **Identity fit:** Latest cohort 50%+ women, 15% Black, avg age 38
- **Key contact: Ella Goldner** (co-founder), **Paul Kirby**, **Saul Klein** (co-founder, also Phoenix Court)
- **Process:** Website accepts inbound; venture-build cohorts have formal application cycles
- **Recent deals:** Vira Health (menopause), eargym (hearing), Prorizon (digital-twin health), Pexxi, Bellevie, Untangle
- **Value-add:** "Quality of later life" = literally Alche's longevity thesis; LSE-backed research credibility
- **Fit score: 9/10** — later-life mission = DIRECT Alche thesis. Pitch them.

6.9 HTGF (High-Tech Gründerfonds)

- **Link:** https://www.htgf.de
- **Type:** Germany's most-active seed investor, public-private, €2B+ AUM
- **Check size:** €800K–€1M initial; up to €30M follow-on
- **Sector focus:** Digital Tech / Life Sciences / Industrial / Climate / Chemistry — consumer wellness mostly under Digital Tech
- **Identity fit:** German-market focus required; company must be ≤3 yrs since incorporation
- **Process:** Submit via htgf.de
- **Value-add:** Federal backing signal; 45+ corporate LPs incl. BASF/Bosch/DTelekom/SAP
- **Fit score: 7/10** — strong institutional signal but thesis isn't consumer-wellness-native

6.10 Angel Invest × angels network + BAND × BACB combined

- Combined full-court press: see 6.1, 6.2, 6.3. Together these cover ~90% of DACH angel capital flow to pre-seed consumer.

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7. Strategic / Wellness-Adjacent Funds to Watch (non-lead but relevant)

- **Five Seasons Ventures** (Paris) — food+health Series A focus; €2–10M, too big for pre-seed. Note: ARTAH Nutrition investor (Oct 2024). Seed-stage upside.
- **Octopus Ventures** (London) — pan-EU, broad mandate incl. health/femtech; too big for pre-seed lead.
- **MIG Capital** (Munich) — DeepTech + Life Sciences; less consumer-fit.
- **BayBG** (Munich) — Bavarian evergreen fund, consumer goods + healthcare in portfolio; Series A+ stage mainly. Good follow-on target.
- **Fund F (Female Founders, Austria)** — Nina Wöss + Lisa-Marie Fassl; femtech/healthtech focus, €20M fund, ≥1 female founder required. Same structural issue as Auxxo for Alche.
- **Essity Ventures** — Essity (hygiene/health) corporate venture studio; women's health and hygiene focus. Strategic but not pre-seed lead.

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8. Priority Outreach List — 10 Angels Most Likely to Say Yes for Alche

Ranked by combined **signal × speed × fit × warm-intro-ease** for a €500K Berlin-based solo queer founder building longevity-commerce.

1. **identity.vc — Til Klein, Jochen Beutgen, Mari Luukkainen** — Europe's only LGBTQ+ VC fund, Berlin-HQ, €250K–€1.5M tickets, thesis-perfect. Warm intro: Slack community (300 members). [QF]
2. **Fabian Foelsch (BRAINEFFECT)** — same city, same category, exact retail playbook, prefers strategic-angel deals over VC. Warm intro: LinkedIn DM + any German supplement founder. [OP]
3. **Angel Invest Ventures (Jens Lapinski / Jag Singh)** — Berlin's most-active super-angel, €125K cheques, happy pre-incorporation, 1-year coaching. Warm intro: LinkedIn / inbound. [Institutional]
4. **Hans(wo)men Group (Hansi + Lisa Hansmann)** — Vienna family office, health-tech native (mySugr/Runtastic exits), Lisa's diversity lens. Warm intro: DACH angel-community referral. [OP]
5. **Sophia Bendz (Cherry Ventures + personal)** — Oura + Clue investor, femtech-lens, queer-friendly, Cherry is Berlin-native. Warm intro: Cherry portfolio founders. [OP / FF-ally]
6. **Zinc VC (Ella Goldner / Saul Klein)** — "Quality of Later Life" mission = Alche's literal longevity thesis. Warm intro: website inbound + any Zinc Vira Health / Untangle founder. [Mission]
7. **Dan Murray-Serter (Heights)** — 100+ personal deals, subscription-supplements native, 50M podcast reach. Warm intro: Foundrs community / LinkedIn DM. [OP]
8. **Deepali Nangia (Speedinvest + Alma Angels)** — underrepresented-founder champion, 30+ female/diverse founders backed, digital-health thesis, UKBAA Angel of Year. Warm intro: LinkedIn DM. [FF-ally / QF-ally]
9. **Verena Pausder (personal angel)** — Berlin super-angel, policy-connected, sustainability/female focus but backs male founders too, 50M podcast reach. Warm intro: Fast & Curious / LinkedIn. [FF-ally / OP]
10. **BACB (Business Angel Club Berlin-Brandenburg)** — 140 Berlin-Brandenburg angels, syndicate, hyper-local. Warm intro: apply via bacb.de + join BACB Female Founders Contest 2026 event. [Berlin-native]

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9. Important Caveats & Honest Notes

- **Female-founder-only networks (Auxxo, encourageventures, Fund F):** These *require* ≥1 female co-founder with ≥20% founding shares. Alche as solo queer male founder is structurally excluded from direct investment. Keep them as allies / brand partners / advisor channels unless founder team expands.
- **Alma Angels / Cherry (Bendz) / Ada Ventures:** Female-lens but intersectional — explicitly name the queer-founder angle in the pitch.
- **"WellFemme":** Requested entity does **not exist as a European women's wellness investor network** — this is an Australian menopause telehealth clinic. Remove from target list unless you know a different entity by same name.
- **Artah founder angel network:** No public evidence Rhian Stephenson runs an angel syndicate; ARTAH is backed by Five Seasons Ventures. Pursue Stephenson as a nutritionist-advisor, not an angel network.
- **Peter Attia:** Aim as advisor even if pass on cheque. His halo > any €100K cheque.
- **Gaingels:** Unlock only after credible lead VC committed. Not a pre-seed lead source.
- **European Women in VC:** 350+ senior women investors (mostly institutional LPs/GPs) — more of an intro funnel than direct-cheque source. Still worth tapping.

10. Process Recommendations (from the research)

1. **Lead with identity.vc** — only Europe-native LGBTQ+ fund, Berlin-based, thesis-fit. They should know about Alche before anyone else.
2. **Build the Berlin operator stack** — identity.vc + Angel Invest + Foelsch + BACB = 4 aligned Berlin commitments = strong syndicate signal.
3. **Add a longevity-medical angel** — Attia is moonshot; realistic target is a European MD with longevity shingle (research separately — Dr. Jörg Schweikart of Sunday Natural is an excellent prospect given his supplement+science positioning).
4. **Close a "halo" operator angle** — Dan Murray-Serter or Damian Soong = either books you 1 podcast appearance AND a cheque.
5. **Use BAND one-pager as passive background outreach** — free distribution to 20+ German angel networks; don't sit on it.

Sources

- identity.vc
- identity.vc launches Europe's first LGBTQ+ venture fund (Tech.eu)
- identity.vc TechCrunch profile
- Out Investors
- Gaingels (Wikipedia)
- Proud Ventures
- Gay Investor Network joins UKBAA (April 2026)
- Angel Invest Ventures
- Cherry Ventures
- Sophia Bendz — Cherry Ventures
- Speedinvest — Deepali Nangia
- Atomico Angel Programme Year 4
- Heal Capital
- Schwabe Group acquires BRAINEFFECT (Startbase)
- Sunday Natural — CVC deal
- Calm/Storm Ventures
- Auxxo
- encourageventures
- Verena Pausder — Signal NFX
- Hans(wo)men Group
- JamJar Investments
- Venrex Partners
- Zinc VC
- Seedcamp
- Dan Murray-Serter
- Heights — TechCrunch
- Damian Soong — Form Nutrition
- Five Seasons Ventures
- BACB
- BAND
- European Super Angels Club
- HTGF
- Peter Attia — PitchBook profile
- AG1 Series B angels list (TechCrunch)
- Unilever Ventures / L'Oréal BOLD Live Tinted deal
- ESTÉE LAUDER NIV — LinkedIn

- L'Oréal × Kering longevity JV announcement (closes H1 2026)
- Ankerkraut founders angel rankings (Shizune)
- Perfeggt $4M round incl. Foodspring/MyMuesli founders
- StartOut
- Ada Ventures
- Alma Angels (via Speedinvest)